



Imaging: Neeta Wadiker

A *FORCE* to reckon with!

PC motherboards are never going to be the same again... and the nForce is here to ensure that

ROSSI FERNANDES

When you have a major system upgrade on the cards for your old PC, the components that you would want to replace are probably your processor or video card/soundcard. A processor upgrade usually means that you would have to consider replacing your motherboard. AMD enthusiasts can now look forward to nForce chipset based motherboards with mind blowing features such as integrated high-end video, surround sound and much more.

nVidia, market leader for 3D graphics cards, has just introduced its first chipset, which will be used in motherboards for AMD's desktop processors. These motherboards, which will probably be available by the third quarter of the year, will

have a GeForce 2 class graphics card and Dolby 5.1 surround sound on board. This implies that you will no longer have to resort to an expensive add-on graphics card or soundcard for decent multimedia performance. The nForce has also integrated an Ethernet card and modem into the motherboard in an attempt to provide high performance at a relatively lower cost than has ever been available before.

The nForce itself

IGP: The North Bridge is one of the most important chips on the motherboard—it is a vital link between the memory subsystem, the CPU itself and the graphical subsystem. The North Bridge on the nVidia motherboards is also called the